

Tips For using MP3 Players



Power is a serious issue with MP3 players as you seldom get the rated battery life. It's just like motorcycle manufacturers claiming incredible mileage for their motorbikes "under standard test conditions". To get the maximum out of the battery, try these techniques.

- Never set the volume level to maximum. This will protect not only the battery life but also your hearing.
- Use headphones that cover your ears completely rather than plugs, because the latter allows other noise into the ears and you will be tempted to increase the volume level.
- From the menu, reduce the time the backlit stays active. The feature is very helpful at night, but eats a lot of power.
- Organise your songs into playlists. For instance, put all rock music into one playlist and jazz into another. This will save you time, and you won't have to access the backlit option for long.
- Always use a good branded battery to avoid leaks that can damage components inside the player and render it unusable.



Since MP3 players are portable devices and are used on the move follow, these tips to ensure long, uninterrupted life.

- Always carry the MP3 player in its carry case.
- Avoid direct contact of other objects with the screen, as it may get scratched.
- Take care of the earphone cord. If it's stretched, it can leave one or both plugs useless.

More music please

Some solid-state MP3 players come with 32 MB or 64 MB memory and cannot store more than 6-12 songs encoded at 128 Kbps. However, you can increase the number of songs—but at the expense of quality. If the Kbps count is decreased to 64 Kbps or lower, the file size will reduce even further and allow you to store more songs. The quality of sound will not be as good as it is at 128 Kbps, and even playing at maximum volume might not be sufficient. To encode the music at a lower or higher bit rate, go to **Tools > Option** in Windows Media Player and click on Devices. Select MP3 player from the list and click Details. The new window will let you set the quality level by dragging the bar to the right or left.



Player On Four Wheels

Bored with the limited number of audio cassettes you have? Dismayed by the quality of music your car audio system plays? Here's a simple solution. If your car deck has a Line-in, most of the problems of connecting an MP3 player to your car deck is solved.

Get an RCA cable from the market, connect the red-connector and white-connector to the car deck, and the single pin connection to your MP3 player's headphone jack. The LCD on your car deck will display auxiliary-in or MP3, which means the MP3 player is successfully connected to the car audio system.

If your car's system doesn't have a Line-in function, you will have to buy a car MP3 adapter. This adapter looks exactly like a

cassette, with a connection port on one end where the stereo cable is connected. The other end goes in the headphone jack on your MP3 player.



The only trade-off is sound quality, which may not be as good as your car deck with Line-out, because there's a magnetic coupling inside your car deck between the cassette head and the car audio's head. This causes magnetic interference, which produces noise and hence loss in quality. But it's still much better than what you get from regular cassettes.

There are car MP3 players available in the market that are hard disk based, and which can be removed and plugged into a PC through a USB connection, but since their prices are very high they are yet to become popular.